

Yemen

June 2022

1,400,000+

IDPs and refugee reached with cash assistance in 2021

105,000+

IDP and refugee families received shelter and NFI kits in 2021

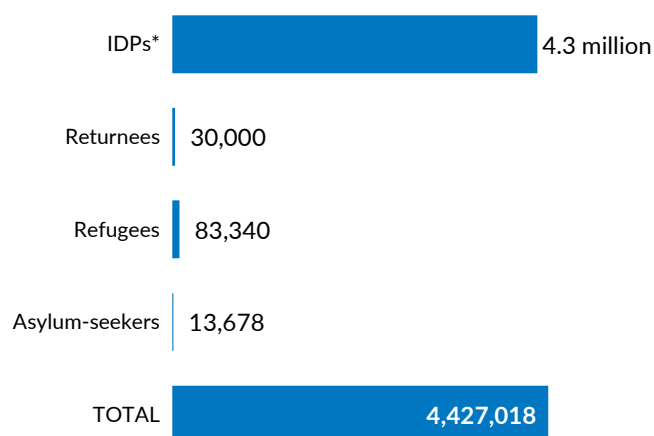
28,000+

IDPs and refugees supported with legal assistance in 2021

41,000+

IDPs and refugees received psychosocial first aid in 2021

POPULATION OF CONCERN

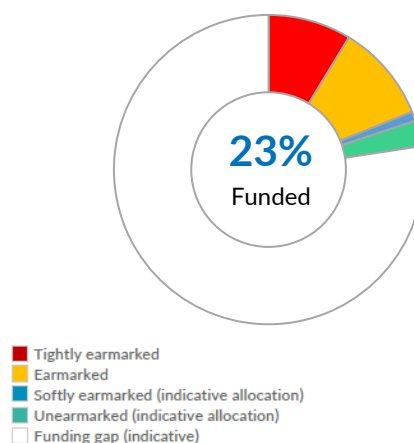


* Internally displaced persons in accordance with latest population update by OCHA.

YEMEN 2022 FINANCIAL REQUIREMENTS

USD 291.3 M

Funding as of 7 June 2022



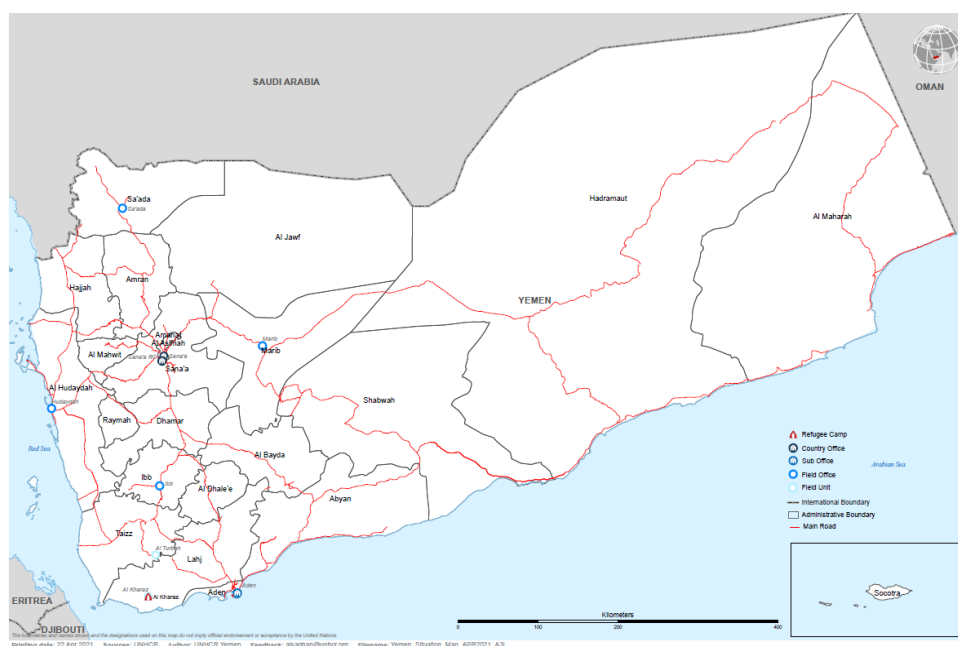
UNHCR PRESENCE

Staff:

- 251 National Staff
- 56 International Staff

Offices:

- Seven offices located in Sana'a, Aden, Marib, Al Hudaydah, Sa'ada, Ibb and Lahj governorates
- Field presence covering most of Yemen's 22 governorates and 333 districts where displaced populations reside



Regular updates on our response can be found on UNHCR's Yemen [Global Focus](#) and [Operational Portal](#)

Operational context

Yemen remains one of the **world's largest humanitarian crises**. After seven years of devastating conflict, some 23.4 million Yemenis (73 per cent of the total population) depend on humanitarian assistance to survive, including 4.3 million IDPs and 97,018 refugees and asylum-seekers. The country has the **fourth largest IDP population due to conflict in the world**. It is estimated that some 286,000 Yemenis were newly displaced in 2021 and so far, close to 40,000 individuals have been forced to flee their homes in 2022. Countrywide, the economy has collapsed and more than 80 per cent of the total population lives below the poverty line. The protracted nature of the displacement, coupled with the socioeconomic downturn, continues to impact the lives of millions of Yemenis and thousands of refugees and asylum-seekers, pushing them into a spiral of negative coping strategies and fuelling protection risks. Above all, **Yemen remains a grave protection and displacement crisis**. The first quarter of 2022 observed a significant increase in clashes between warring parties, with almost one civilian killed or injured every hour during the first month of the year. The situation, however, has changed significantly following the signing of a truce agreement on 1 April negotiated by the UN with each of the parties to the conflict. With an initial duration of two months, extended on 2 June for an additional two months, the parties have committed to halt all offensive military operations, including cross-border attacks, allow fuel ships to dock in Al Hudaydah ports, reopen Sana'a airport for commercial flights and open the Taiz road.

Key figures



23.4 million
Yemenis in need



7.9 million
Yemenis in acute need



4.3 million internally displaced Yemenis



97,018 refugees and asylum-seekers (mainly Somalis and Ethiopians)



79% of IDPs assessed are women and children



3.8 million IDPs are projected to be highly food insecure



1.6 million IDPs living across 2,300 informal sites



80% of Yemenis live below the poverty line

Main activities

As part of the inter-agency humanitarian response to assist those most in need in Yemen, **UNHCR leads the Protection, Camp Coordination and Camp Management (CCCM), and Shelter/Non-Food Items (NFI)** also known as core relief items or CRI) clusters. UNHCR also co-leads with IOM the Refugees and Migrants Multi-Sector response. All interventions conducted by the Operation are guided by the Tri-Cluster approach whereby UNHCR aims to promote the complementarity of its interventions for all displaced populations and communities hosting them. A summary of the 2022 country strategy is available on [Global Focus](#).

Protection

As the Protection Cluster Lead Agency, UNHCR plays a critical role in promoting the **protection of civilians** with a focus on IDPs and the impact of the conflict on civilians, dedicating efforts to guarantee the access to safe areas and humanitarian assistance. Protection monitoring teams across the country – in the 12 community centres supported by UNHCR or mobile teams – further help identify those in need of specialised protection services and conduct public and private advocacy with parties to the conflict on an ongoing basis. Maintaining the capacity to conduct **protection monitoring** is critical to inform analysis, evidence-based advocacy and the delivery of assistance. UNHCR has in place monitoring tools at community and household level feeding into vulnerability criteria used for assistance eligibility and to identify the primary areas of need.

As part of its interventions, UNHCR further provides a wide range of protection services including: identification and referral of vulnerable persons to specialized services; legal assistance (awareness, individual counselling and representation) largely on civil matters and with particular attention to civil-status documentation; psychosocial first aid

and psychosocial support; assistance for survivors of gender-based violence (GBV) or children with specific needs, and awareness-raising and capacity-building activities on protection issues to partners and authorities.

Cash-based interventions

One of the primary ways UNHCR assists vulnerable displaced Yemeni and refugee families to meet their most basic and pressing needs is through the **distribution of cash assistance**, including multi-purpose cash assistance (MPCA), rental subsidies, and emergency and winter cash. These cash streams are all anchored in UNHCR's protection mandate as protection risks are part of the eligibility criteria. UNHCR hosts the largest vulnerability and socio-economic database with 1.2 million IDPs and refugees and 300,000 members of the host community assessed over the last 12 months. As markets are functioning and accesible to Yemenis, unconditional cash provides an efficient way to meet the needs of those affected by displacement, allowing families to prioritize their own needs while upholding their dignity and making them less likely to resort to harmful coping mechanisms. These interventions also work to reinforce the local economy and markets. In 2021, UNHCR assisted over 1.4 million IDPs and refugees with cash. **In 2022, UNHCR aims to reach some 1.5 million IDPs and 50,000 refugees with cash assistance.** Post-distribution monitoring (PDM) shows that up to 91 per cent of displaced Yemeni families receiving cash spend all or part of it on food, while shelter-related needs remain a key priority for beneficiaries. The cash programme in Yemen is among UNHCR's top five cash programmes globally, and the second largest dedicated to IDPs.

Shelter and core relief items

As the Shelter Cluster lead for IDPs in Yemen, UNHCR provides **emergency shelter and basic household items** such as mattresses, blankets, kitchen sets and solar lamps, especially to newly displaced families. UNHCR has produced emergency shelter kits adapted to the local weather and locally procured materials, contributing to the local economy and assisting recently displaced individuals become self-sufficient. UNHCR also upgrades emergency shelters, providing dignified and sustainable shelters for up to five years. The Operation further supports IDPs at risk of eviction through rental subsidies. **In 2022, UNHCR aims to provide rental subsidies to some 54,000 vulnerable IDP families and distribute 55,000 emergency shelter kits, 20,000 transitional shelters and 70,000 core relief item kits.**



A widowed Yemeni woman living with her kids in and IDP site in Sana'a. They are among the more than 1.6 million displaced Yemenis living in sites in need of support. UNHCR, © Alejandro Staller

Camp coordination and camp management

More than 1.6 million IDPs are estimated to live in 2,300 IDP sites across Yemen, with only half are supported by humanitarian actors. As the CCCM Cluster lead, UNHCR works with local authorities and partners to provide coordinated services to displaced Yemenis in IDP hosting sites and surrounding communities. This translates into contributing to **ensure adequate shelter and common infrastructures in IDP hosting sites**. In addition, UNHCR maps needs and gaps in the interventions and works to mitigate the threat of eviction from sites in the proximity of active areas of conflict (some 45 per cent of sites are within 5 km of such areas). UNHCR further supports analysis and response on housing, land, and property (HLP) issues and is engaged in exploring ways to reinforce support from local authorities to identify public land and upgrade shelter conditions in collective centres and IDP hosting sites.

Area-based approach

UNHCR advocates with the humanitarian community and donors to implement an area-based approach whenever feasible and allow all displaced (IDPs and refugees) and host populations to benefit from humanitarian assistance and development initiatives from all relevant actors. Through this approach, UNHCR implements projects benefitting both the displaced population and host communities. **This type of initiatives include cash for employment modalities and frequently focus on WASH, renewable energy and rehabilitation of common infrastructure.** A wide-range of these interventions have been conducted recently in Basateen neighbourhood in Aden governorate, benefitting more than 70,000 refugees, IDPs and members of the host community. Among the projects implemented, UNHCR constructed and maintains three primary schools and two clinics, including a health centre receiving 1,500 consultations per week. In addition, other projects include monthly

cleaning campaigns, upgrading water resources, rehabilitating water and sanitation networks, and installing of solar-powered street light poles to improve safety and security and reduce GBV risks.

Comprehensive refugee response

UNHCR is the main agency addressing the protection and well-being of over 97,000 refugees and asylum-seekers across Yemen, mainly from Somalia and Ethiopia, although advocating for other agencies to extend their services to this population. Yemen is the only country in the Arabian Peninsula to have ratified the 1951 Refugee Convention and its Protocol. The Government of Yemen has granted *prima facie* status to Somali nationals since 1991, while the de facto authorities have revoked this practice as of 2018. Since 2016, UNHCR has devolved registration and documentation responsibilities to the authorities, but the registration of asylum seekers has yet to resume in the areas under the de facto authorities. On 24 July, the head of IPNA in the north authorised the registration of new-born children. Kharaz camp, located in Lahj governorate and currently hosting over 9,600 refugees is the only refugee camp in the country. In the camp, UNHCR still provides a full range of services and assistance, including food and shelter support. A Self-Reliance and Solutions Strategy is currently being designed. Through facilities in refugee-hosting areas, **UNHCR provides a series of protection services to extremely vulnerable refugees and asylum-seekers**, including case management and fostering arrangements for unaccompanied and separated children, multi-sector assistance to GBV survivors, psychosocial support for persons in distress and legal assistance, including in detention. In addition to protection services, UNHCR provides cash assistance to the most vulnerable individuals, as well as basic services such as health and education, in coordination with relevant authorities. While durable solutions remain limited, advocacy to increase resettlement opportunities continues, and efforts are ongoing to restart the process of voluntary return to Somalia, halted by the pandemic.

Inter-agency advocacy

Under its leading role of the Protection, CCCM and Shelter/NFI Clusters, UNHCR regularly advocates for its Tri-Cluster approach through which joint interventions are conducted, including on: joint site identification (demining, site planning), policy on civilian character of sites and non-encampment, HLP issues, eviction guidance (including joint displacement tracking), and support for community engagement and protection considerations, among others. UNHCR also plays a key role in inter-agency coordination, ensuring that displacement issues are well reflected in both humanitarian and development planning documents, including in relation to durable solutions. UNHCR leads advocacy on the protection of civilians especially in relation to the impact of the conflict on displaced populations.



Working with partners

UNHCR as part of the UN Country Team, leads the Protection, CCCM and Shelter/NFI clusters, including sub-clusters and technical working groups. UNHCR also participates in inter-agency working groups, including the Humanitarian Access Working Group, the Mental Health and Psychosocial Support Working Group, and other specialized task forces. Along with its 20 implementing partners – most of whom are national NGOs – UNHCR holds regular meetings to **promote and set policy standards, address challenges and monitor performance**. UNHCR also maintains regular contact with the Supreme Council for Management and Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (SCMCHA), the National Committee for Refugee Affairs (NACRA), the Executive Unit, and the Department of Immigration, Naturalization and Passports Authority (IPNA) as the respective authorities' bodies covering key humanitarian matters. By strengthening its collaboration with UN partners, such as UNICEF, UNHCR has also reinforced common strategies on child protection, education, and birth registration in the context of interventions for refugees; UNFPA on GBV protection; WFP on food distribution in Kharaz refugee camp; and IOM as a strategic partner for the Ethiopian and Somali returns programmes and mixed population flows especially on the border with Saudi Arabia.

Special thanks to donors

UNHCR is grateful for the critical support provided by donors to UNHCR's 2021 humanitarian response in Yemen: [United States of America](#) | [Sheikh Thani Bin Abdullah Bin Thani Al-Thani Humanitarian Fund](#) | [Germany](#) | [CERF](#) | [King Salman Humanitarian Aid and Relief Center](#) | [Japan](#) | [Sweden](#) | [Kuwait Fund for Arab Economic Development](#) | [France](#) | [Switzerland](#) | [UNO-Fluechtlingshilfe](#) | [Qatar](#) | [Qatar Charity](#). And by major donors of unearmarked contributions: [Norway](#) | [Other Private Donors](#) | [Netherlands](#) | [Denmark](#) | [Belgium](#) | [Ireland](#).

More information

For more information please visit the [Yemen Global Focus](#) and [Yemen Operational Portal](#) and keep further updated through:  [UNHCR Yemen Twitter](#)  [UNHCR Yemen Facebook](#) and  [UNHCR Instagram](#)

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